# RESOLUTION

## Incident Management Framework

*Restore · Verify · Monitor · Close*

**OBJECTIVE**

Restore service, confirm stability, and close the incident properly.

# AGENDA

## 01 Resolution Overview

What is incident resolution?

## 02 Implement Fix

Step 1 of resolution

## 03 Verify Recovery

Step 2 of resolution

## 04 Monitor Post-Fix

Step 3 of resolution

## 05 Communication

Stakeholder updates

## 06 Documentation & Closure

Record & close properly

# RESOLUTION OVERVIEW

## What is Incident Resolution?

Incident resolution is the final and critical phase of the incident management lifecycle. It involves:

- Restoring normal service as quickly as possible
- Verifying the fix is stable and effective
- Monitoring for recurrence post-fix
- Communicating outcomes to all stakeholders
- Documenting root cause and preventive actions

*The goal is not just to fix the symptom, but to restore value delivery to the business while minimizing the probability of recurrence.*

**60%** of incidents resolved within SLA when structured process is followed

**3x** faster resolution with documented runbooks vs ad-hoc responses

**40%** reduction in repeat incidents with proper root-cause documentation

# STEP 1 — IMPLEMENT FIX

*Apply the identified fix with minimal disruption to the business.*

1. **Identify Fix Type**
   Determine whether the fix is a config change, patch, rollback, failover, code hotfix, or infrastructure change.

2. **Obtain Approvals**
   Follow Emergency Change process. Notify Change Manager and relevant approvers if required by policy.

3. **Assign Resources**
   Engage the right technical team. Ensure on-call engineers, vendors, or escalation paths are activated as needed.

4. **Execute the Fix**
   Implement the fix per the approved procedure. Follow runbooks where available. Log all actions with timestamps.

5. **Parallel Run / Fallback**
   Maintain fallback plan in case fix fails. Define rollback criteria and rollback steps before executing.

# STEP 2 — VERIFY RECOVERY

*Validate that the service has been fully restored and performs as expected.*

## TECHNICAL VERIFICATION

- Confirm service is accessible and responding
- Run smoke tests / functional tests on affected components
- Check error rates returned to baseline
- Confirm monitoring alerts are cleared

## BUSINESS VERIFICATION

- Validate with end-users or business owners
- Confirm dependent systems unaffected
- Review application and system logs for residual errors
- Verify SLA status and record Resolution Time

# STEP 3 — MONITOR POST-FIX

*Maintain heightened monitoring to confirm stability and catch any recurrence early.*

| | |
|---|---|
| **0–1 hrs** | **Immediate Watch**<br>High-frequency checks. All hands on deck. Watch for alert recurrence or cascading failures. |
| **1–4 hrs** | **Active Monitoring**<br>Continue enhanced monitoring. Track KPIs: error rate, latency, throughput, CPU/memory. |
| **4–24 hrs** | **Stabilization**<br>Confirm sustained performance. Reduce check frequency. Notify on-call team of watchlist items. |
| **24–72 hrs** | **Post-Incident Watch**<br>Extended observation window. Confirm no latent issues. Prepare for formal post-incident review. |

# COMMUNICATION

## Update Stakeholders

- Send restoration notification to all impacted stakeholders
- Confirm service is back to normal
- State time of restoration and brief cause summary
- Use pre-defined communication templates where available

## Final Incident Notification

- Issue the formal 'All Clear' communication
- Include: Incident ID, affected services, timeline
- Confirm no further action needed by recipients
- Archive notification in incident record

## Business Impact Summary

- Quantify downtime duration and scope
- Identify impacted user groups and geographies
- Estimate business cost where applicable
- Link to SLA breach report if thresholds were exceeded

# DOCUMENTATION

## RECORD THE FOLLOWING

### Root Cause

If known, describe the underlying cause, not just the symptom

### Resolution Actions

Every action taken, by whom, at what time

### Recovery Timestamps

Time of detection, escalation, fix, and full restoration

### Preventive Actions

List changes to prevent recurrence; create Problem Record if needed

## INCIDENT CLOSURE

### Category

Select the correct incident category in ITSM tool

### CI (Config Item)

Link the affected Configuration Item accurately

### Resolution Code

Apply the correct resolution code (e.g., Fixed, Workaround)

### Problem Record

Raise a Problem if root cause is unknown or recurring

### Customer Confirmation

Obtain user/business owner sign-off before closing

# BEST PRACTICES & KEY TAKEAWAYS

### Follow Emergency Change Process

Never bypass change management even during incidents. Emergency change approvals protect the business from unauthorized changes.

### Document Everything in Real Time

Record all actions with timestamps as they happen. Memory fades. Real-time logs are your best post-incident evidence.

### Root Cause Over Quick Fixes

Address the root cause, not just the symptom. Quick workarounds without root cause analysis lead to recurring incidents.

### Link to Problem Management

For recurring or major incidents, always raise a Problem Record to drive long-term prevention and reduce incident volume.

### Communicate Proactively

Silence breeds anxiety. Regular updates even when there's nothing new reassure stakeholders and build trust.

### Track and Improve MTTR

Measure Mean Time to Restore. Use data to identify patterns, optimize runbooks, and continuously reduce resolution time.

# RESTORE. VERIFY. CLOSE.

*A disciplined resolution process reduces downtime, rebuilds trust, and prevents recurrence.*